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BUS 198

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1. Provide a brief overview of the internship, the number of hours worked, what you did.

My internship position this summer was titled Content Coordinator with Poppy Gifting. Poppy gifting is a personal and corporate gifting company that curates thoughtful presents for individuals and businesses. The company offers gifting services as well as The Shoppe, a collection of carefully selected gifts available for direct purchase. My position specifically focused on The Shoppe and managing its marketing content. I did various remote work that consisted of planning out their editorial calendar, content creation, asset management, and community management. I developed content plans for Instagram, LinkedIn, and TikTok using Planoly and Notion. Additionally, I assisted with content creation and executed on average 5 posts per week. Each week, the content I worked on included gift picks, the owners' "Weekly Wrapped" favorites, product highlights, sales announcements, and similar features. After posting the content, I was responsible for responding to post comments and DMs. I also helped bring to life content collaboration partnership posts on Instagram. Lastly, I participated in weekly meetings with the company's marketing and social planner to review the previous week's content and analyze performance metrics.

I worked approximately 10–15 hours per week, with my internship running from mid-June through early September. Overall, my days consisted of planning and creating posts and content on Planoly and Notion while collaborating with the co-founders to understand their vision and goals.

2. What were some of the new things that you learned during the internship?

Prior to this internship, I had little experience using Canva, Planoly, and Notion. In the beginning Canva felt very foreign to me. I felt like there were so many different things to play with, I didn't know where to start. Over time I really got the hang of it and started to really enjoy creating assets for the brand's social media. Additionally, Notion was something I had no clue what it was before this internship. Poppy Gifting uses the website as an all-in-one workspace. If I had any questions about calendars, aesthetics, mood boards, or even just password information I would look to notion for help. It really helped me stay organized throughout the summer and it helped me see what was coming next. Lastly, Planoly is an app that allows you to schedule Instagram posts in advance, so you don't have to publish them manually on the day of posting. This app, although tricky for me to handle at first, was extremely helpful to organize and get ahead on assets for Poppy Gifting's Instagram page. Overall, Canva, Notion, and Planoly were tools I loved learning to use, as they helped me stay organized, understand the brand's goals, and create cohesive, engaging content.

Additionally, I learned how to actively communicate with the co-founders, Peggy and Willa, as well as their marketing consultant, Emily Singer. They were incredible resources that helped me with creative ideas and overall kept me informed on the latest updates. I think working with such a small team helped me adapt quickly to the environment, as I was immediately immersed in the workflow and responsibilities. I also think I learned how important direct communication was when not fully understanding what was asked of me. I effectively communicated what I needed from them whether it was a blurb from one of the founders or

photos, etc. I also learned that it is okay to speak up when you have questions or comments on new ideas being shared. This helped create a very comfortable and idea driven community. Overall, this internship not only strengthened my technical and creative skills but also taught me the value of clear communication, adaptability, and collaboration within a small, fast-paced team environment.

3. What were some of the things that surprised you?

Although I knew that Poppy Gifting was a fairly new and small company, I didn't know the extent of it at the time. Poppy Gifting has an extremely small team that is ran by the cofounders. I was really shocked to see how involved the founders were with Poppy Gifting's social media presence. They actively involved me in bringing their vision to life, which made the experience especially meaningful for me.

Additionally, I was a bit surprised by how often social media ideas and posts came together on short notice, but it taught me how to be flexible and think creatively under tight timelines. I experienced a fast-paced work environment with timely deadlines throughout the week, which was something I hadn't fully anticipated going into the internship. I was also surprised by how much they valued my ideas when talking through ideas for their brand and how to display different companies in The Shoppe; their online retail store.

Working for Poppy Gifting was a rewarding experience that allowed me to grow creatively, strengthen my communication and organizational skills, and gain valuable insight into the world of digital marketing within a small business.

4. How will you use the learnings from this internship to position yourself for a job interview? i.e.what have you learned to do well due to your experience.

Through my internship this summer I have learned how to manage social media content from planning to execution. Additionally, I was able to adapt quickly in a fast-paced environment and communicate effectively with both founders and marketing consultant. I've also become confident using tools like Canva, Notion and Planoly to help me stay organized and on track with the company's goals. This internship and the tools I have gained have strengthened my creativity, time management, organization, and overall collaboration skills. These things mixed with examples during an interview will display how this boosts me as a great candidate for the role.

5. Are there any specific insights or observations related to the EMPAC model that you learned during your internship?

During my internship, I observed the importance of matching in retail marketing. Matching came to play when I created social media content that aligned with the brand's vision and its target audience. For example, I highlighted gift picks, weekly favorites, and product features to guide consumers to select items that suited their gifting needs. The content I created acted as a form of matching because it helped shoppers make choices by giving context to the gifts sold and why they can help the consumer. I also experienced the entertainment aspect to the EMPAC model. By creating fun and creative content every week, I helped create a small 'retail experience' that made browsing fun. The content I created encouraged consumers to explore products and feel inspired by our gifting habits.